

# Find My Ride

Reducing uncertainty when riders and drivers cannot convert an app pin into a workable meeting point

62

unique survey submissions

24 / 51

recent users reporting difficulty

4

driver responses — evidence gap

3

research-led ideas to test

# What we actually researched

A deliberate method choice under constraint — stated up front, not buried in a footnote.

## METHOD CHOICE

Synchronous interviews were not feasible in the available window. I built a multilingual self-serve research app instead: rider/driver branches, structured tags, and four optional open-text or voice prompts.

## DEPTH ACHIEVED

62 unique respondents. 30 answered at least one open-ended narrative prompt, 11 gave extended accounts, and 3 completed all four detailed prompts.

## TRADEOFF

No live probing and no follow-up on surprising answers. Depth per respondent is lower than a moderated interview; breadth, language coverage and traceability are higher.

62 unique submissions • 58 riders • 4 drivers • 33 Hyderabad / 29 other cities • 30 open-ended responses

The screenshot shows a mobile app interface titled "Pickup Story". At the top, there are three language selection buttons: "EN" (highlighted in orange), "TE", and "HI". Below the title, it says "6 / 17". The main prompt is: "Tell us about the most recent time this happened — from booking until you met your driver, or the ride was cancelled." This is followed by a horizontal line and the word "Optional". Below this is a text input area with the placeholder text "Type here, or tap the mic to speak...". To the right of the input area is a microphone icon. Below the input area, there is a small text note: "Tap the mic to speak your answer instead of typing." At the bottom of the screen, there are two buttons: "Back" and "Next" (highlighted in orange).

Live app  
English • Telugu • Hindi

<https://praveenveera.github.io/uber-pickup-survey/>

Full consent, question-flow, and anonymized-response evidence is included in the evidence ZIP.

# Guidance exists — focus on coverage, clarity, and recovery

Competitor evidence establishes design precedents, not validated Hyderabad outcomes.

## UBER HYDERABAD BASELINE

Uber's HYD guidance points riders to in-app directions and a D1 pickup zone. The case is not “Uber has no pickup guidance.”

## GLOBAL PATTERNS

Grab uses venue visuals and meeting points. Lyft uses pickup notes. Waymo makes accessible stops and walking trade-offs explicit.

## INDIAN ACCESS PATTERN

MyGate shows how a privacy-aware gate handoff can work. Historical Ola evidence shows physical zones or human help, but not a current capability.

## Product implication

**Test a reusable coordination layer for complex places: valid stopping context, concise handoff information, and one visible recovery step when coordination stalls.**

Restrictions to design around: no-stopping and access rules, venue operations, accessibility, privacy, and data minimization. Exact local rules require venue-level validation.

# A sizing model with a named missing denominator

Refusing a fabricated TAM is the finding — not an omission.

## SIZING MODEL

Annual affected pickups = Hyderabad Uber four-wheel pickups × share beginning at complex locations × share hitting material difficulty. None of the three inputs exists in a reliable public source, so no TAM is claimed.

## EXPOSURE POOLS — NOT THE PROBLEM

Hyderabad Airport: 30M+ passengers FY2025-26. Hyderabad Metro: 4.75 lakh+ average daily riders across 57 stations. Secunderabad station: ~1.30 lakh per normal day, 2 lakh+ during festivals.

## WHERE DEMAND CONCENTRATES

Segment by location type, not demographics. Among 28 issue cases: airport 10, gated residential 7, mall 6, office 6, metro/rail 5, street 3, hotel 2, hospital 1.

## Market trends

Regulatory tailwind — MV Aggregator Guidelines 2025 mandate in-journey location sharing, accessibility features and language support.  
Category maturing — Uber already ships HYD airport guidance; Lyft ships pickup notes; Grab ships venue meeting points.  
Curb space tightening — access-control windows now appear at Indian transport hubs, such as Secunderabad's 15-minute pickup/drop rule.  
Privacy bar rising — the DPDP Act 2023 constrains how venue and location data can be collected and retained.

Telangana's adoption of the 2025 central guidelines and venue-level stopping rules both require legal and on-site verification. This is product research, not legal advice.

# One research question grounded in a clear problem frame

Primary: Hyderabad four-wheel riders at complex pickups. Connected stakeholder: the driver.

**When a pickup becomes difficult, what breaks, and what do riders and drivers do to recover?**

## EVIDENCE-BASED PROBLEM

At complex pickup locations, an app pin may identify the area without giving rider and driver a shared, workable meeting point. Observed impact: extra calls, waiting, movement, and delay.

## WORKING JTBD • ASSUMPTION

When I am waiting at a complex pickup, help my driver and me agree on a legal, easy-to-recognize meeting point so the trip can start with less recovery effort.

**Success direction: fewer reactive contacts and lower arrived-to-trip-start dwell. Driver and marketplace impact still requires validation.**

# Five questions before writing the problem statement

The 5Ws define the context and impact without jumping to a feature.



## WHO

Hyderabad four-wheel  
riders

The driver is the  
connected stakeholder.



## WHAT

A generally correct pin  
may still fail to create  
one shared, workable  
meeting point.



## WHERE

Airports, gated homes,  
malls, offices, and  
metro or railway  
stations.



## WHEN

After booking, mainly  
as the driver  
approaches or is  
marked arrived.



## WHY

Extra calls, waiting,  
movement, and  
delayed trip starts  
reduce pickup  
reliability.

**Evidence check: the survey supports the direction, but root causes, driver impact, and venue constraints still need moderated and field validation.**

# A specific, evidence-based, and focused statement

1

## SPECIFIC USER

Hyderabad four-wheel riders starting from complex pickup locations.

2

## CLEAR PAIN

The rider and driver lack one shared, workable meeting point.

3

## VISIBLE IMPACT

Extra calls, waiting, movement, and delayed trip starts.

4

## DEFINED SCOPE

Airports, gated residences, malls, offices, and stations.  
Not every ride.

## FINAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

**For Hyderabad four-wheel riders starting from complex locations, the pickup pin may show the correct general area but still fail to give the rider and driver one shared, workable meeting point.**

**This causes extra calls, waiting, movement, and delayed trip starts.**

**Uber should solve this to reduce recovery effort and improve pickup reliability, while respecting driver access and stopping constraints.**

Evidence boundary: directional survey evidence. Moderated interviews and stronger driver validation are still pending.

# Ten questions adapted for the online instrument

Required interview prompts used asynchronously; no live follow-up or probing.

- Tell me about the last time you had difficulty finding your ride after booking it.
- Where were you, and what did the app tell you?
- When did you first realize the pickup might not work as expected?
- What made the rider and driver difficult to locate or identify?
- What did you do next: call, message, move, wait, cancel, or seek help?
- How much extra time or effort did the situation require?
- What finally helped, if anything?
- Has the same problem happened at other locations?
- What information or support was missing at the most frustrating moment?
- For drivers: what prevented you from reaching the pin or identifying the rider?

Method boundary: the form could not probe vague answers or ask a live follow-up.

## Not everyone's problem — but a real, recurring one for affected respondents

Headline signals and a direct quote; the complete ten insights appear in the appendix.

47.1%

24 of 51 recent users reported  
difficulty or uncertainty

82.1%

23 of 28 issue cases said it happened  
before

20 / 28

said calling or messaging helped

6 / 28

said nothing helped

*“The app says he has arrived, but almost 10 minutes to locate each other.”*

R067 • rider • anonymized response

Interpretation boundary: 23 of 28 means the issue occurred before; it does not prove recurrence at the same venue. These sample percentages are not Hyderabad prevalence. The 28 issue cases are the 24 recent four-wheel users plus 3 respondents with no recent four-wheel trip and 1 unsure, all of whom reported a pickup issue.

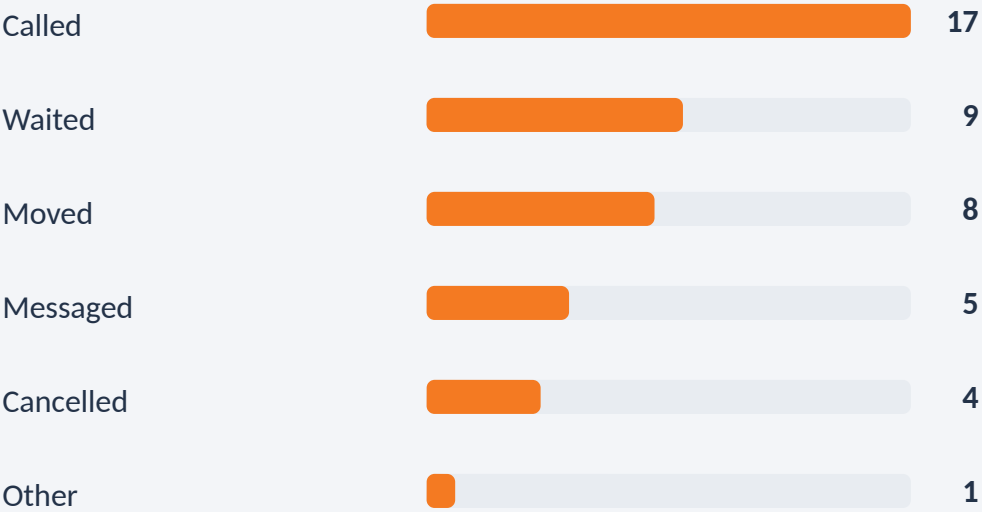
# Where coordination breaks — and how people recover

Supporting visual for the location and recovery insights.

## Problem locations among 28 issue cases — top 6 of 8 types



## Recovery actions



The app often hands the last physical coordination step back to the rider and driver. Calls work often — but they add effort and do not provide a reliable fallback when coordination still fails.

# Make the fallback faster — not the map more complicated

## Recommended direction

**Reduce the effort and uncertainty of manual pickup recovery at a defined set of complex location types.**

### TEST ORDER

- P0 • Structured pre-arrival meeting note
- P1 • Guided stalled-pickup recovery
- P2 • Venue-specific coordination information

### DO NOT

Do not add friction to every ride, position this as an airport-only problem, or treat all cancellations as map failures.

**Biggest open risk: driver evidence and marketplace economics are too thin to support a two-sided rollout decision.**

# Structured pre-arrival meeting note

Strongest first test because it formalizes an existing user-created workaround.

## TRIGGER

Only at flagged complex pickup locations, a few minutes before driver arrival.

## ACTION

Prompt one concise handoff: gate or side, landmark, and waiting spot — reusable where appropriate.

## WHY THIS FIRST

Calls/messages helped in 20 of 28 issue cases. R061 already sends these details manually — and reported no pickup difficulty.

## TEST

At comparable flagged locations, compare reactive call/message rate, arrived-to-trip-start dwell, location changes, and cancellations.

*“I always place a message on where I would stand with details.” — R061*

## Recovery when coordination stalls — then reusable venue context

### P1 • GUIDED STALLED-PICKUP RECOVERY

Trigger after an arrived state remains unresolved past a defined threshold. First guide reconnect actions: share live location, confirm a meeting cue, and retry contact. Test reassignment only for unresolved cases, because it carries marketplace and compensation risk.

### P2 • VENUE-SPECIFIC COORDINATION INFORMATION

Pilot at 2–3 validated venues. Show accessible gate or side, legal stopping point, expected walk, and access constraints. Treat repeat-issue evidence as a problem signal — not proof that the same venue failed repeatedly.

**Guardrails: trigger only on genuine coordination stalls; assign venue-data ownership and expiry; validate driver impact before scaling.**

## A defensible direction — not a “build it” recommendation

**Test the smallest coordination aid first: a structured note at flagged complex pickups. Move to recovery and venue data only if the evidence supports it.**

### LIMITS

Convenience sample; interview requirement unmet; 4 drivers; optional open-text depth; 29 other-city responses; no reliable local market denominator.

### NEXT RESEARCH

Run 6 moderated rider and 4 driver interviews if feasible; include accessibility and venue-operations perspectives.

### NEXT DATA

If event logs are trustworthy, baseline arrived-to-trip-start dwell, contacts, location changes, and cancellations at selected venues.

*Appendix: full method, framing check, top 10 insights, competitor patterns, idea tests, limitations, and source traceability.*

## APPENDIX

# The evidence behind every claim

Methodology · Problem-framing check · Top 10 insights · Market and competitor patterns · Strategy reconciliation · Product tests · Limitations · Sources

# Online survey evidence and the exact requirement gap

- 62 unique submissions after removing confirmed duplicate R032
- 58 riders and 4 drivers; driver conclusions remain open
- 33 Hyderabad and 29 other-city responses
- Self-serve, asynchronous, consent-gated interface in English, Telugu, and Hindi
- Four optional open-text or voice prompts plus structured tags
- Contact details and raw payload excluded from the sanitized workbook
- Asynchronous online research, not synchronous in-depth interviews: 30 respondents answered open-ended prompts, but no answer could be probed live

The image displays two screenshots of a mobile application interface titled "Pickup Story".

**Left Screenshot (Screen 11 / 17):**

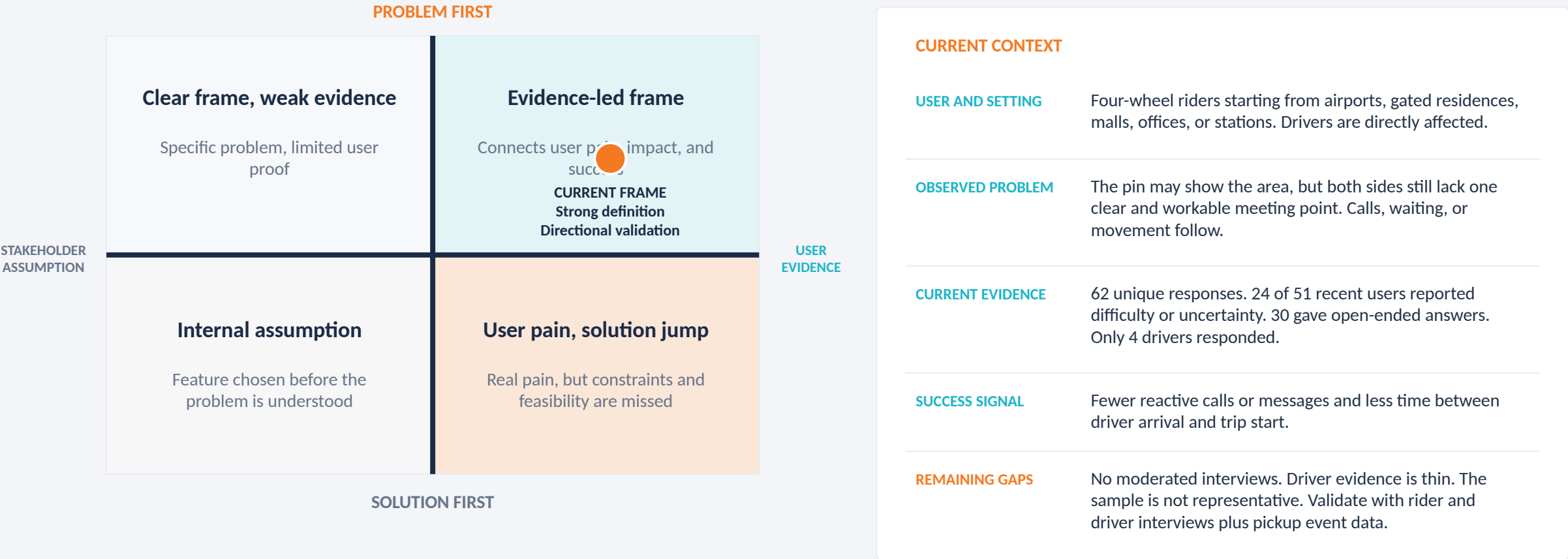
- Header: "Pickup Story" with language selection buttons (EN, TE, HI).
- Progress indicator: "11 / 17".
- Title: "Where were you? (choose all that apply)".
- Options (each with a checkbox):
  - Airport
  - Shopping mall
  - Office or tech campus
  - Metro or railway station
  - Hospital
  - Hotel or event venue
  - Busy street
  - Residential complex / gated
  - Other
- Navigation buttons: "Back" and "Next".

**Right Screenshot (Screen 14 / 17):**

- Header: "Pickup Story" with language selection buttons (EN, TE, HI).
- Progress indicator: "14 / 17".
- Title: "What finally helped, if anything? (choose all that apply)".
- Options (each with a checkbox):
  - Calling or messaging each other
  - Walking to a shared landmark
  - Driver moved closer to me
  - Security or staff helped
  - Nothing helped — had to cancel
  - Something else
- Navigation buttons: "Back" and "Next".

Live app and full-size screenshots are included in the evidence ZIP.

# Current problem frame and validation status



**Assessment: strong problem framing with directional validation. Test the smallest idea while gathering stronger evidence.**

## Insights 1–5: prevalence, recurrence, location, arrived state, and recovery

1

### Difficulty is meaningful, not universal

24/51 reported difficulty or uncertainty; 34/62 no issue

Strong

2

### For affected respondents, the issue often recurs

23/28 said it happened before — not necessarily same venue

Strong

3

### Complex environments concentrate coordination failures

Airport 10; residential 7; mall 6; office 6

Strong

4

### Arrived does not mean the rider and driver can meet

Wrong pin, similar gates, cross-road case

Moderate

5

### Calling and messaging are the main recovery layer

20/28 said calling or messaging helped

Strong

## Insights 6–10: recovery burden, delay, cancellation, support, and identification

- |    |                                                                                                                |          |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 6  | <b>The rider often absorbs the recovery effort</b><br>Waited 9; moved 8; driver moved helped 3                 | Moderate |
| 7  | <b>Pickup failures can create material delay</b><br>7/10 time-tagged cases exceeded five minutes               | Moderate |
| 8  | <b>Cancellation is related but multi-causal</b><br>Location overlaps with destination, fare, payment, and rain | Moderate |
| 9  | <b>Some respondents found no effective recovery</b><br>6/28 selected nothing helped                            | Moderate |
| 10 | <b>Finding the ride includes vehicle identification</b><br>One vehicle-number mismatch report                  | Weak     |

## Design patterns — with transferability limits

| Reference       | Observed mechanism                        | Lesson for this case                                   | Boundary                     |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Uber HYD</b> | In-app directions and D1 pickup zone      | Baseline exists; test coverage and failed coordination | Airport-only evidence        |
| <b>Grab</b>     | Venue visuals and curated meeting points  | Make landmarks and paths concrete                      | Global / experimental claims |
| <b>Lyft</b>     | Pickup Notes and selective assisted rides | Structured context and recovery precedent              | US market                    |
| <b>Waymo</b>    | Navigable stops; walking preference       | Explain vehicle-access vs walking trade-off            | US autonomous rides          |
| <b>MyGate</b>   | Privacy-aware gate handoff                | Access-aware residential coordination                  | Adjacent Indian product      |

# What the evidence changes — and what it does not support

## PARTIALLY SUPPORTED

Indoor-to-outdoor navigation matters, but gated residences, offices, and streets show a broader shared-reference-point problem.

## SUPPORTED, THIN

Access and stopping constraints matter; driver evidence is only four responses, so desk research carries more weight here.

## SUPPORTED

“Pickup failure” combines location confusion, recovery effort, destination preference, fare, payment, and driver behavior.

## NOT SUPPORTED

A universal prompt, airport-only strategy, precise Hyderabad prevalence, or a driver-specific solution cannot be justified from this evidence.

## DECISION

Use location type and stall signals to target coordination help. Validate rider benefit and driver impact before building a broader venue data operation.

## Three ideas, sequenced by evidence strength and operating risk

| #         | Idea                                    | Trigger / scope                          | Primary measures                            | Main risk                           |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>P0</b> | <b>Pre-arrival meeting note</b>         | Flagged complex location; before arrival | Calls/messages, dwell, location changes     | Added friction if over-triggered    |
| <b>P1</b> | <b>Guided stalled-pickup recovery</b>   | Arrived state unresolved past threshold  | Resolution and unresolved-cancellation rate | False triggers; driver compensation |
| <b>P2</b> | <b>Venue-specific coordination info</b> | 2–3 validated venues                     | Calls/messages and dwell vs matched venues  | Stale rules; ownership cost         |

Sequence is a test order, not a committed build roadmap.

## What kind of evidence this is

- Convenience sample recruited through available networks; not representative of Hyderabad riders
- Online survey with interview-style prompts; 30 open-ended responses but no live probing, so qualitative depth is shallower than a moderated interview
- Four driver responses; two-sided product and marketplace conclusions remain premature
- Open prompts were optional and the schema changed during collection, so qualitative depth varies
- Twenty-nine of 62 responses came from other cities; they are comparison evidence, not a small side sample
- Consent was required in the interface but not stored as a separate backend field
- Multi-select location and action counts are mentions, not mutually exclusive people
- No reliable Hyderabad trip-volume or issue-rate denominator was found; no market-size figure is claimed

# Every claim traces to a source or an explicit limitation

## PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Sanitized-Survey-Evidence.xlsx  
Survey-Dashboard.png  
Screenshots/  
Live-URL.txt

## DESK AND COMPETITOR EVIDENCE

Competitor-Analysis.md  
Desk-Research-Report.md  
Source-Register.md  
Raw internet workbook retained privately

## SYNTHESIS

01-survey-insights.md  
02-strategy-implications.md  
04-product-ideas.md

## HARD SUBMISSION GATE

Video link is pending. Before submission: record presenter-visible video under 5 minutes, upload it, add the working link, and verify access.

Evidence ZIP excludes participant contacts, raw API payloads, test rows, internal artifacts, and the raw internet workbook containing public creator contacts.